Day 74 - Ivan Lemcke, Rush Cove Rd, Ivan Lemcke Connector

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Peninsula section · hike 98 · Rush Cove Rd, near Barrow Bay

5.0 km / 3.1 mi	~1.8 h	2.7 km new	203 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

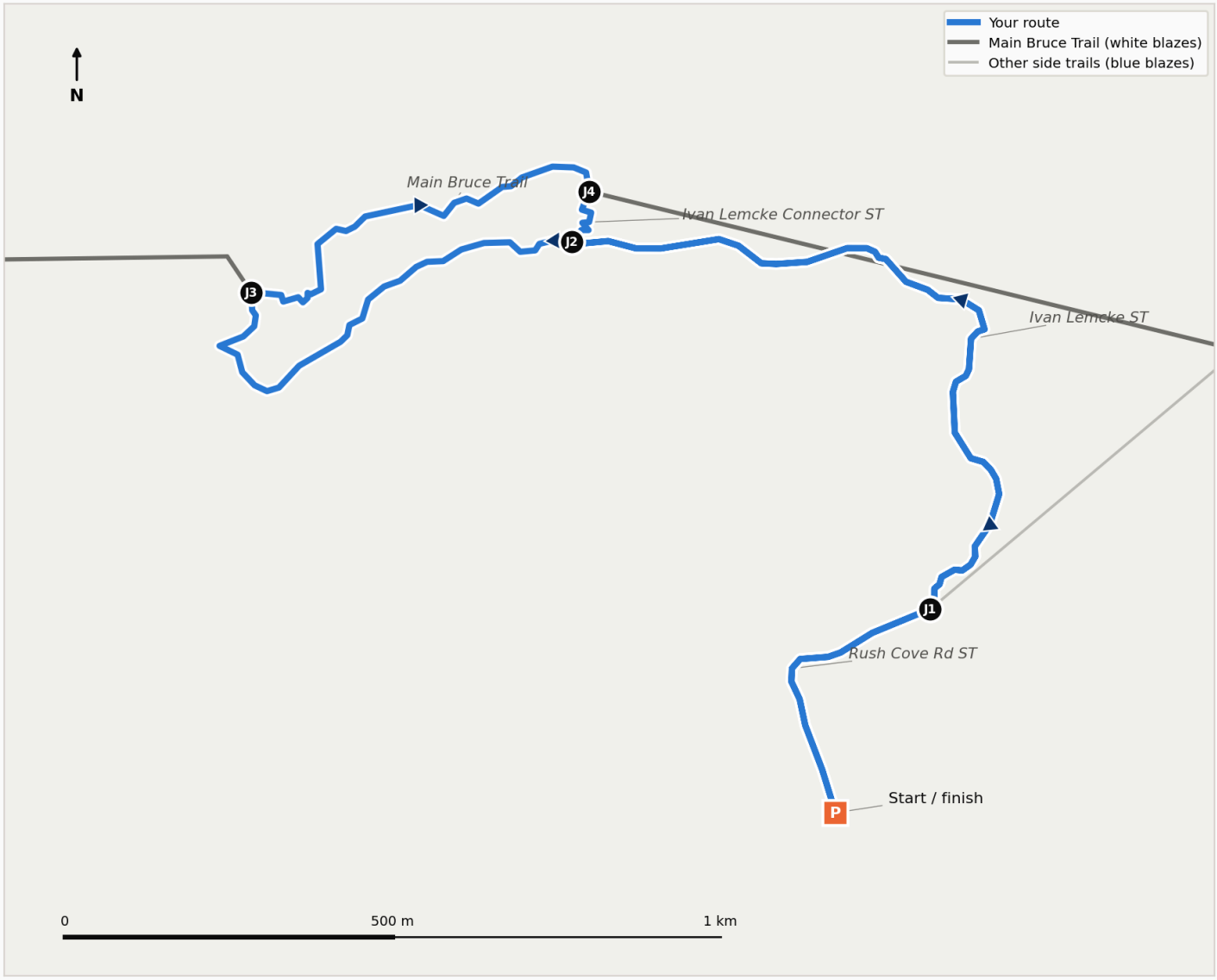
Park (P): A large area on the west side of Rush Cove Rd, 750 metres north of Scenic Caves Rd. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day74_hike098.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Ivan Lemcke Side Trail (2.1 km); Rush Cove Rd Side Trail (0.5 km); Ivan Lemcke Connector Side Trail (0.1 km)

Route map

Day 74 | 5.0 km (3.1 mi)



What to expect

- **Parking:** A large area on the west side of Rush Cove Rd, 750 m north of Scenic Caves Rd.
- **Road walking:** The Rush Cove Rd Side Trail follows the road shoulder at the start and end. Keep Zappy close.
- **Ivan Lemcke Side Trail:** The main loop of the day, joined to the main trail by a short connector. We found no detailed description of its terrain or features.
- **Area context:** In 2020, the Peninsula Bruce Trail Club moved about 7 km of the main trail off Rush Cove Rd, Scenic Caves Rd and Bruce Rd 9. It now runs through the Barrow Bay Cliffs Nature Reserve, which has cliffs, lookouts and dense forest.

Parking options

No other official Bruce Trail parking lies within about 1 km of this route. If you need to stop early, turn back the way you came; the GPS track records what you covered, and the website shows what is left.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: A large area on the west side of Rush Cove Rd, 750 metres north of Scenic Caves Rd. Head north on the blue-blazed Rush Cove Rd Side Trail. The next 0.5 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
0.5	0.3	J1: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Ivan Lemcke Side Trail, heading north. (the blue-blazed Rush Cove Rd Side Trail goes off ahead.)
1.7	1.1	J2: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Ivan Lemcke Side Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Ivan Lemcke Connector Side Trail goes off on your right.)
2.5	1.5	J3: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
3.2	2.0	J4: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Ivan Lemcke Connector Side Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
3.3	2.0	J2: Turn sharp left onto the blue-blazed Ivan Lemcke Side Trail, heading east. (the Ivan Lemcke Side Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
4.5	2.8	J1: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Rush Cove Rd Side Trail, heading south-west. (the blue-blazed Rush Cove Rd Side Trail goes off on your left.) The next 0.5 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
5.0	3.1	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Bruce Peninsula Press.